

HOUSE No. 196**The Commonwealth of Massachusetts**

PRESENTED BY:

James C. Arena-DeRosa

To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act maximizing participation in federal nutrition programs and improving customer service.

PETITION OF:

NAME:	DISTRICT/ADDRESS:	DATE ADDED:
<i>James C. Arena-DeRosa</i>	<i>8th Middlesex</i>	<i>1/15/2025</i>
<i>Mindy Domb</i>	<i>3rd Hampshire</i>	<i>1/24/2025</i>
<i>James B. Eldridge</i>	<i>Middlesex and Worcester</i>	<i>3/3/2025</i>
<i>Antonio F. D. Cabral</i>	<i>13th Bristol</i>	<i>3/17/2025</i>
<i>Mike Connolly</i>	<i>26th Middlesex</i>	<i>3/20/2025</i>
<i>Hannah Kane</i>	<i>11th Worcester</i>	<i>3/25/2025</i>
<i>Bruce E. Tarr</i>	<i>First Essex and Middlesex</i>	<i>4/7/2025</i>
<i>Vanna Howard</i>	<i>17th Middlesex</i>	<i>4/7/2025</i>
<i>Lindsay N. Sabadosa</i>	<i>1st Hampshire</i>	<i>4/7/2025</i>
<i>Tara T. Hong</i>	<i>18th Middlesex</i>	<i>4/7/2025</i>
<i>Susannah M. Whipps</i>	<i>2nd Franklin</i>	<i>4/7/2025</i>
<i>Samantha Montaño</i>	<i>15th Suffolk</i>	<i>4/16/2025</i>
<i>Sean Garballey</i>	<i>23rd Middlesex</i>	<i>4/28/2025</i>
<i>Margaret R. Scarsdale</i>	<i>1st Middlesex</i>	<i>5/13/2025</i>
<i>Erika Uytterhoeven</i>	<i>27th Middlesex</i>	<i>5/19/2025</i>
<i>Natalie M. Higgins</i>	<i>4th Worcester</i>	<i>8/8/2025</i>
<i>Marjorie C. Decker</i>	<i>25th Middlesex</i>	<i>9/15/2025</i>

HOUSE No. 196

By Representative Arena-DeRosa of Holliston, a petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 196) of James C. Arena-DeRosa, Mindy Domb and James B. Eldridge relative to participation and customer service in federal nutrition programs. Children, Families and Persons with Disabilities.

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

An Act maximizing participation in federal nutrition programs and improving customer service.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1 Section 16 of chapter 6A of the General Laws, as so appearing, is hereby amended by
2 inserting the following paragraph:-

3 Notwithstanding any general or special law to the country, within three months of
4 enactment, the Executive Office of Health and Human Services shall submit a report to the house
5 and senate committees on ways and the committee on children, families, and persons with
6 disabilities specifying the resources the department of transitional assistance requires to assure
7 timely participation by eligible households in federal nutrition assistance benefits administered
8 by the department, provided that the report shall set forth (a) the department's short- and long-
9 term goals for improving benefits access and providing timely customer service to eligible
10 households; and (b) the financial and other resources the department needs to reach those goals.